

Principles of Microeconomics

ECON 1101

Course Info

 Tue & Thu

 (Sec D) 10:05 - 11:30 am

 Searles - 213

 (Sec E) 1:15 - 2:40 pm

 Roux - 207

Instructor Info

 **Seeun Park**
(pronounced SEH-n; she/her)

 Office Hrs:
Tue 3 - 4 pm,
Wed 3 - 4:30 pm,
Thu 3 - 4 pm
“or” by appointment

 Hubbard Hall - 8

 s.park@bowdoin.edu

Learning Assistants & Graders

 **Owen Benison**
(he/his; LA)

 LA Hrs: Mon

 Location:

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 **Brooke Landry**
(she/her; LA & Grader)

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 **Ricky Volpe**
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1 Overview

Economics is the study of how individuals, businesses, and governments make choices about allocating limited resources to achieve their goals. In this course, we focus on the behavior and decision-making of economic agents, such as consumers and firms, using theories of demand, supply, cost, and market structures. You will apply economic principles covered in the class to real-world problems, which will help you develop a deeper understanding of the world.

2 Learning Objectives

By the end of the course, you should be able to:

1. **Identify** introductory microeconomic topics and concepts related to supply and demand, producer and consumer choice, and how the market works in today's society.
2. **Describe** economic concepts in your own words using relevant real-world examples
3. **Use graphs and basic math/formulas to explain** the discussed economic ideas
4. **Analyze** and **evaluate** real-world situations using course concepts
5. **Create** original explanations of discussed economic concepts using real-world examples and creative formats

3 Course Materials and Devices

- **Interactive Notes:** Interactive Notes are templates with key concepts, examples, and exercises to help you engage with the material. Download them from Canvas to use on a tablet or print them out.
- **Textbook:** The textbook is *Principles of Microeconomics* (3rd ed.) by OpenStax. A PDF is available on Canvas.
- **Canvas:** Canvas will be the course hub for announcements, materials, assignments, feedback, and other resources. Check it regularly and turn on notifications to stay updated.
- **Gradescope:** You will submit your Problem Sets on Gradescope. A link to submit your work on Gradescope will be posted on Canvas.
- **Poll Everywhere:** Poll Everywhere will be used for real-time engagement and feedback during lectures. Download the Poll Everywhere app and enter **seeunpark775** to join. (If you need additional help, see the registration instructions on Canvas.)

4 Grading Scheme

Here's how your grade will be determined, with each assessment weighted as follows:

10%	Problem Sets (8 sets; the lowest 1 will be dropped)
12%	Quizzes (7 quizzes; the lowest 1 will be dropped)
60%	Exams (3 exams, 13%, 23%, and 24%)
5%	Econ Conversation
13%	Econ-in-the-Wild Project (10% written analysis, 3% peer review)

Final course grades are based on the weighted average of all course components.

Grades follow the standard scale:

A	[95.00,100]	A–	[90.00,94.99]		
B+	[87.00,89.99]	B	[83.00,86.99]	B–	[80.00,82.99]
C+	[70.00,79.99]	C	[65.00,69.99]	C–	[60.00,64.99]
D	[50.00,59.99]	F	<50		

Final scores within 0.20 percentage points of a cutoff may be rounded up at my discretion. Because adjustments are already applied before grades are set, I do not consider individual requests for further rounding.

If a grading error is made, tell me and I will fix it. A request to re-evaluate an exam more broadly means the entire exam is regraded against the original standards, and the resulting score may be lower.

4.1 Problem Sets

Problem sets (PS) provide an excellent opportunity to apply economic concepts to analyze and evaluate real-world problems using graphs, equations, and models. They are graded primarily on completion and effort, not correctness. The real test of whether you understood the material is the quiz that follows.

- Problem sets will be posted on Tuesday after 5 PM and are **due the following Tuesday at 9 AM**.
- **Late submissions** will be accepted until **Thursday at 9 AM** with a 20% deduction. No submissions will be accepted after this deadline.
- Answer keys will be posted after class on Thursday. You are expected to review them.
- **Out of a total of 8** problem sets, the lowest 1 will be dropped.
- When working in groups, submit your own work and list your group members (see Group Work).
- Problem sets **must be submitted on Gradescope**, not Canvas. These are practice for the quizzes and exams. Work through them yourself. Turning to generative AI, such as ChatGPT or Claude, will cost you on the quiz that follows.
- *It is your responsibility to check that your problem set is correctly uploaded.* Any corrected upload after the deadline, or any failure to upload on time, will be treated as late or missing.

4.2 Quizzes

Quizzes are a low-stakes way for both of us to see where you stand before each exam. They cover the material from the problem set due that morning and are written to resemble exam questions in form, so you can calibrate your preparation while there is still time to adjust.

- Quizzes are taken **in class at the start of Tuesday's meeting**, on the day a problem set is due. Each quiz is about 10 minutes and is closed book, closed notes, and closed friends.
- **Out of a total of 7** quizzes, the lowest 1 will be dropped. Each of the remaining 6 is worth 2%.
- If you **arrive late**, you may take the quiz in the time remaining. No additional time will be given.
- **No makeup quizzes** will be offered. If you miss one, it will be the quiz that is dropped. Additional missed quizzes will receive no credit unless the absence is documented through your dean or is due to an official College commitment. In those cases, an additional quiz will be dropped.
- *Quizzes begin promptly at the start of class.* Plan to arrive on time.

4.3 Exams

There will be three exams in this course:

Exam	Date	Time	Material Covered
Exam 1 (13%)	Tue, Oct 6	During Class Time	Modules 2–5
Exam 2 (23%)	Thu, Nov 5	During Class Time	Modules 6–9
Exam 3 (24%)	Thu, Dec 17 (Section E)	1:30 – 4:30 PM Roux 207	Modules 10–13
	Mon, Dec 21 (Section D)	8:30 – 11:30 AM Searles 213	

Each Exam will focus on the modules listed above, but key concepts from earlier course material may also appear. Additional details about exam format and policies will be announced before each exam.

4.4 Econ Conversation

Each student will participate in one 20-minute Econ Conversation, in groups of three (a few will be pairs), **during Exam 1 week**. The conversation is designed to assess your understanding of economic concepts and your ability to explain your reasoning in your own words. You may be asked to interpret graphs, discuss real-world examples, respond to follow-up questions, or work through a problem with your group.

Additional details, scheduling instructions, and the evaluation rubric will be provided before the conversations begin.

4.5 Project: “ECON-IN-THE-WILD”

Throughout the semester, I will share real-world examples with you. For this project, you’ll find your own example from the world (“wild”) and share it with your classmates. For more details, please refer to the separate project document.

Version	Deadline*	Notes
First	Thu, Nov 19	Initial submission (9-hour grace period).
Peer Review	Thu, Dec 3	In-class anonymous peer review. Instructor comments returned afterward.
Final	Tue, Dec 15	Optional revision with a brief revision note. [†] If not submitted, the first version becomes the final version.

* All deadlines are 11:59 PM ET.

[†] Revision recovers at most half the points lost on the first version (e.g., 80 → 90, 92 → 96).

5 Attendance

Because this course relies heavily on in-class discussions and group activities, regular attendance and active engagement are expected. I take attendance at each meeting.

Up to 3 absences carry no penalty, and you do not need to explain or document them. Beyond that, absences cap your final grade: 4 absences at A–, 5 at B–, 6 at C–, and **7 or more result in a failing grade**. From the 4th absence on, documentation through your dean or an official College commitment means the absence does not count toward this total.

6 Late Work Policy

6.1 Make-up Exams

Students are expected to take all exams at the scheduled time. Make-up exams will be permitted only under the following circumstances:

- **Prior approval** for scheduled conflicts, such as religious observances, university-sponsored activities, or other approved academic commitments. Students are responsible for notifying me well in advance so that alternative arrangements can be made.
- **Serious unexpected medical or family emergencies.** In these situations, please notify me as soon as possible. You should also contact your Dean, who may coordinate with me regarding appropriate accommodations.

Make-up exams are intended only for exceptional circumstances, and documentation or Dean verification may be required. Make-up exams will cover the same material but **may differ in format or include modified questions or numerical values** to help maintain academic integrity. Students are expected to take the make-up exam as soon as reasonably possible after the original exam.

Because the date of **Exam 3** is announced on the first day of the semester, please **plan travel accordingly**. Requests to reschedule the final exam for personal travel will not be approved. Exceptions require approval from the student’s Dean.

6.2 Late *Problem Set* Submissions

Since the lowest problem set (PS) is dropped, no make-up assignments will be given. You may either skip one problem set with no explanation needed or submit late with a 20% deduction. Late submissions will be accepted until **Thursday at 9:00 a.m.** Any work submitted after that deadline will receive a zero. Answer keys will be posted after class on Thursday.

If an unexpected illness or family emergency prevents you from submitting on time, please notify me as soon as reasonably possible. Extensions without penalty may be granted in exceptional circumstances.

6.3 Late *Project* Submission

The first version is due on Thursday, November 19 at 11:59 PM, with a **9-hour grace period**. This deadline is set before Thanksgiving break so that you can rest and I can read your work carefully. Submissions received after the grace period **may not receive instructor feedback** before the final revision. Please contact me as soon as possible if an emergency prevents you from submitting on time. (See Project Deadlines.)

6.4 Extra Credit

To keep grading fair and consistent, no extra credit will be offered in this course.

7 Group Work

This course is designed around in-class group activities, with much of our second weekly meeting devoted to collaborative problem-solving. You are welcome to work with others on problem sets outside of class as well, but you must **submit your own work** and **list the names of your group members** on your submission. A helpful way to approach problem sets is:

- Review the notes.
- Attempt all practice questions on your own.
- Meet with your group to discuss the problem set.
- Write up and submit your own answers after the discussion.

8 Academic Integrity

Academic integrity means **doing your own work honestly** and giving proper credit when you use others' ideas. You can read more about Bowdoin's Academic Honor Code and related policies on Canvas.

8.1 Uses of Generative AI

Generative AI can be a useful learning tool, but this course emphasizes learning by working through problems yourself. Problem sets are graded largely on completion, because their purpose is practice rather than assessment. The quiz on the morning each set is due is where that practice gets tested, so work through the problems on your own. On the project, the analysis and writing must be your own, and I may ask you to explain any part of it in person. If you need help or clarification, I encourage you to seek assistance from me, the learning assistant, or your peers.

On the project, you may use AI for limited purposes such as grammar or style checking and citation formatting. If you are unsure whether a particular use is appropriate, please feel free to ask me.

9 Communication

9.1 Canvas

Course announcements will be posted on **Canvas**. Please turn on notifications (*do this now!*).

9.2 Office Hours

The best way to get support is during Office Hours, which are dedicated to helping you succeed in this course. I encourage you to stop by with questions about lectures, problem sets, exams, projects, or economics in general.

If the scheduled Office Hours do not fit your schedule, you can book an appointment (or scan below), or email me if none of those times work either.



9.3 Email

Email is best for scheduling, brief questions, or issues that cannot wait until class or office hours. Questions that require more detailed explanations are often better discussed in person.

I aim to respond to emails within 24 hours on weekdays, though messages sent after 6 PM may be answered the following day. To help me identify course-related messages more quickly, please begin the subject line with **ECON 1101** (e.g., ECON 1101 – Extra Office Hour).

If you notice any errors or have questions about grading, please contact me directly rather than the graders.

10 Tips for Success in this Class

1. **Attend class:** Annotated notes will be posted, but being present makes the material clearer and easier.
2. **Ask questions:** Whether in class, during Office Hours, or by email.
3. **Stay engaged:** Active participation reinforces learning.
4. **Check Canvas and email regularly:** Stay up to date and avoid missing important announcements or materials.
5. **Review notes daily:** Revisiting notes each day helps solidify your understanding.
6. **Understand the material before practicing:** Practice is most effective once the concepts are clear.
7. **Work on problem sets independently:** Try them on your own first, then discuss with others or ask me or the LA for help. On exams, you'll be on your own.
8. **Talk to me if something is unclear:** Reach out anytime. I'm here to help.

11 Student Support Resources

11.1 Accommodations

You may need accommodations for different reasons, such as a documented disability or observing a major religious holiday.

- **Disability accommodations:**
 - Register with the **Student Accessibility Office**.
 - Once approved, please meet with me within the first 2 weeks of class (or as soon as you become aware of your needs) to ensure they are implemented.
 - Check the exam and quiz schedule early and reserve your test center seat as soon as reservations open, since popular times can fill up.
- **Religious observances:** You may make up coursework missed due to observing a major religious holiday, provided you make arrangements with me in advance and notify me within the first 2 weeks of class.

11.2 Academic, Personal, and College Support

Bowdoin provides many resources to support your success, well-being, and sense of belonging in this course and beyond.

- **Baldwin Center for Learning and Teaching (BCLT):** Peer tutoring, writing help, Q-Tutors for Math/Science/Stats/Econ, and academic mentoring.
- **Counseling Services:** Confidential mental health support and resources.
- **College Policies:** Bowdoin is committed to diversity, inclusion, and a safe learning environment. This includes policies related to Title IX and mandated reporting. Full details and resources are available on Canvas.

12 Class Schedule

Week	Date	Topic	PS (Posted)*	PS (Due)* Quiz **	Chapter
1: How Markets Work					
1	Sep 1	Introduction: Course Overview & Module 1: Thinking Like an Economist			1.1-1.3
	Sep 3	Module 2: Gains from Trade			2.2
2	Sep 8	Module 2 (cont.)	PS 1		19.1-19.2
	Sep 10	Module 2 (cont.)			
3	Sep 15	Module 3: Demand and Supply	PS 2	★PS 1	3.1-3.3
	Sep 17	Module 3 (cont.)			
4	Sep 22	Module 4: Elasticity	PS 3	★PS 2	5.1-5.2, 5.4
	Sep 24	Module 4 (cont.)			
5	Sep 29	Module 5: Price Controls		★PS 3	3.4
	Oct 1	<u>Review</u>			
6	Oct 6	Exam 1			
	Oct 8	Econ Conversation			
2: When Markets Don't Work					
7	Oct 13	<i>Fall vacation</i>			
	Oct 15	Module 6: Market Outcome & Tax Incidence	PS 4		3.5, 5.3
8	Oct 20	Module 7: Externalities		★PS 4	12.1-12.3, 13.1-13.3
	Oct 22	Modules 6 & 7 (cont.)			

* **Problem Sets (PS)** will be posted by 5 PM and are due by 9 AM on the specified dates.

** A **quiz** is given in class on each PS due date that falls on a class day.

Week	Date	Topic	PS (Posted)*	PS (Due)* Quiz **	Chapter
3: How Consumers and Firms Behave					
9	Oct 27	Module 8 Consumer Choice	PS 5		6.1-6.2
	Oct 29	Module 9 Business Costs and Production			7.1-7.5
10	Nov 3	<u>Review</u>		★PS 5	
	Nov 5	Exam 2			
11	Nov 10	Module 10: Firms in a Competitive Market	PS 6		8.1-8.4
	Nov 12	Module 10 (cont.)			
12	Nov 17	Module 11: Monopoly	PS 7	★PS 6	9.1-9.2
	Nov 19	Module 11 (cont.)		Project V1[†]	
13	Nov 24	<i>Thanksgiving</i>			
	Nov 26	<i>Thanksgiving</i>			
14	Dec 1	Module 12: Monopolistic Competition		★PS 7	10.1
	Dec 3	“ECON-IN-THE-WILD”			
15	Dec 8	Module 13: Oligopoly	PS 8		10.2
	Dec 10	Module 13 (cont.)			
16	Dec 15	<i>Reading Period (Dec 12-16)</i>		★PS 8 Project V2[‡]	
	Dec 17	Exam 3 (Section E)			
	Dec 21	Exam 3 (Section D)			

* **Problem Sets (PS)** are due by 9 AM on the specified dates.

** A **quiz** is given in class on each PS due date that falls on a class day.

† The **first version** of the project (**Project V1**) is due Thursday, Nov 19 at 11:59 PM.

‡ The **final version** of the project (**Project V2**) is due Tuesday, Dec 15 at 11:59 PM

13 Important Dates

Date	Event
Tue, Sep 15	<i>Add/Drop ends at 5:00pm</i>
Tue, Oct 6	Exam 1 (in-class)
Wed, Oct 7 – Thu, Oct 8	Econ Conversation
Tue, Oct 20	<i>Extended Course Drop ends</i>
Thu, Nov 5	Exam 2 (in-class)
Thu, Nov 19	Project V1 due (11:59 PM)
Tue, Dec 15	Project V2 due (11:59 PM)
Thu, Dec 17	Exam 3: Section E (1:30 – 4:30 PM, Roux 207)
Mon, Dec 21	Exam 3: Section D (8:30 – 11:30 AM, Searles 213)
Mon, Dec 21	Last day to initiate the <i>Incomplete</i> for the course